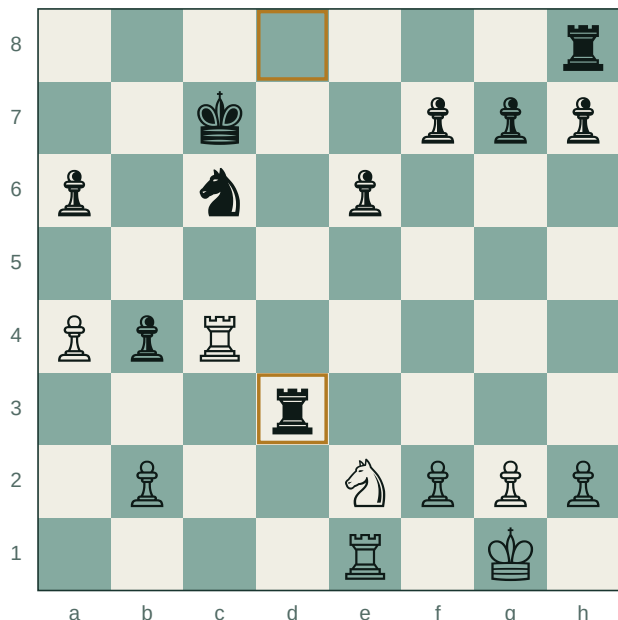


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 22

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rxd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22. Rec1 Rd6 23. Nd4 Rxd4 24. Rxd4

22.Rec1 The rook moves from e1 to c1. Recorded reply: **22...Rd6**.

23.Nd4 The knight moves from e2 to d4. Recorded reply: **23...Rxd4**.

24.Rxd4 The rook captures the rook on d4. The changed line means the rook on c1 attacks the knight on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on c7. Absolute pin: knight on c6.